

ALERT ID	SOURCE SYSTEM	ALERT TIME	ANALYST
CLD-010011	User-Reported Email (soc@cloudora.io)	2026-09-01 08:19 UTC	Eshak Basta

ALERT (WHAT FIRED, ON WHOM OR WHAT):

- `lucas.ford@cloudora.io` (Accounts Payable) reported an email from `billing@meridianoffice.example` with the subject "Overdue invoice INV-2214, second reminder." The email contained a PDF attachment (`INV-2214.pdf`). The user stated, "Not sure we use this supplier. Have not opened the attachment. Or I do not think I did." The message was received at 08:19 UTC.

HYPOTHESIS (BOTH DIRECTIONS):

- Malicious: A finance-themed phishing email is attempting to deliver a malicious PDF attachment to an Accounts Payable employee.
- Benign: The email is a legitimate invoice reminder from a real supplier that the user does not recognize.

EVIDENCE CHECKED:

- Reviewed `02_reported_supplier_invoice.eml`.
- Confirmed SPF passed for `meridianoffice.example`.
- Confirmed DKIM was not configured.
- Confirmed DMARC was not configured.
- Verified that the From, Return-Path, and Reply-To fields matched.
- Reviewed the email body and identified invoice-related language, a request for payment within seven days, and a PDF attachment.
- Confirmed the attachment was omitted from the training copy and had not been detonated or scanned.
- Confirmed there was no evidence available to verify the supplier relationship or determine whether the attachment had been opened.

VERDICT:

True positive	False positive	Duplicate	Escalate	Insufficient data
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SEVERITY:

- Sev 3 – Possible malicious activity requiring additional investigation.
- The email targeted an Accounts Payable employee and contained an invoice-themed PDF attachment. However, the available evidence does not support either a confirmed phishing verdict or a legitimate business email verdict. Additional evidence is required before the alert can be reclassified.

ACTION:

- Gather additional evidence and place the ticket on hold while awaiting the required information.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION REQUIRED AND HOW TO OBTAIN IT:

- Contact Accounts Payable to determine whether Meridian Office Supplies is an approved vendor and whether invoice INV-2214 exists.
- Obtain the original INV-2214 . pdf attachment and submit it to a sandbox for analysis.
- Run a tenant-wide message trace to determine whether other employees received the email.
- Follow up with Lucas Ford to confirm whether the attachment was opened and, if so, identify the device involved.

JUSTIFICATION:

- A final verdict cannot be defended because the supplier relationship is unverified, the attachment has not been analyzed, and the user's interaction with the attachment remains uncertain. Additional evidence is required before the alert can be closed, escalated, or confirmed as malicious.

MITRE ATT&CK:

- NONE

